

UNRETIRE

THE PRACTICE TOOLKIT

One small experiment a week. No pressure. Just forward motion.

A free companion tool from

UNRETIRE

Life after work is just the beginning.

Start Where You Are

Most people wait for the perfect plan. They wait for the right time, the right mood, the right amount of certainty. The plan never comes. The drift does.

Years ago, I learned something in a small falafel shop in Amman. The cook did not study the chickpeas for an hour. He did not wait for inspiration. He reached in, shaped one, and dropped it in the oil. Then the next. Then the next. The shop ran on motion, not on planning.

Your next chapter works the same way.

You do not need a five-year vision to begin living fully again. You need one small action this week. Then another the week after. Small steps are not a lesser path. They are the only path that lasts.

This is not a course to finish. It is a menu to sample. Pick one experiment. Try it for a week. Keep what gives you energy. Leave the rest.

There are no grades here. No streak to protect. No way to fall behind. There is only forward motion — one practice, one week, one small step at a time.

So here is the only question that matters this week: which one will you try first?

How It Works

1 Pick one.

Each week, choose a single experiment from the seven Practices below. Just one. The smallest one that sparks a little curiosity is the right one.

2 Try it for a week.

Apply it to your real life. It costs little. It asks for minutes, not months. Notice how it feels.

3 Keep what lights you up.

If it gave you energy, do it again or go deeper. If it didn't, no harm done — next week, pick another. Every experiment teaches you something about your next chapter.

Remember: motion beats perfection. A small step taken always beats a big plan delayed.

The Seven Practices

Your toolkit is built around the seven UnRetire Practices — the “doing” side of a fulfilling next chapter. Each one offers four simple experiments. Twenty-eight in all. Enough to carry you forward for half a year, one week at a time.

Practice 1	IGNITE	Fuel Passion & Purpose
Practice 2	MOVE	Reclaim Vitality at Any Age
Practice 3	CONNECT	Build a Circle That Lifts You
Practice 4	CONTRIBUTE	Offer Wisdom Without the Lecture
Practice 5	EXPLORE	Use the Power of Novelty and Play
Practice 6	GROW	Grow Wisdom and Inner Alignment
Practice 7	OPTIMIZE	Manage Your Resources by Your Design

PRACTICE 1

IGNITE

Fuel Passion & Purpose

Purpose is not found. It is discovered.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

□ **Host one “Why I Wake Up” coffee**

Invite two or three people for coffee. Ask one question: what gets you out of bed now? Listen more than you talk. You will leave with energy you did not arrive with.

□ **Build a passion board**

Cut out images, quotes, and words that light you up. Pin them where you will see them every morning. Let your eyes remind you who you are becoming.

□ **Write “What I Live For Now”**

One page. No audience. Do not publish it unless you want to. The point is to say your purpose out loud, even if only to yourself.

□ **Mentor someone half your age — once**

Reach out to one younger person. Share one story from your life. A single conversation can hand them a map you spent decades drawing.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 2

MOVE

Reclaim Vitality at Any Age

The body believes what you ask of it.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

☐ **Make a three-song morning playlist**

Pick three songs that move you. Play them while the coffee brews. Start the day with rhythm instead of routine.

☐ **Take a “Steps and Smiles” walk**

Set a small daily step goal. Add one thing that makes you smile — a song, a friend, a scenic route. Movement and joy belong together.

☐ **Learn one new movement**

A yoga pose. A tai chi form. A single dance step. New movement wakes up parts of your body — and brain — that have been waiting.

☐ **Try a sport as a beginner**

Pickleball. Water aerobics. Anything you have never done. Being a beginner again keeps you young in the only place that matters: your mind.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 3

CONNECT

Build a Circle That Lifts You

A life is measured by the people in the room.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

☐ **Make one “reconnect” call**

Choose one person from your past. Call them — do not text. Most old friendships are not broken. They are just waiting for one nudge.

☐ **Send one handwritten letter**

In a world of screens, a letter is a gift. Write to someone who shaped you. Tell them what they never knew they gave you.

☐ **Host a family recipe night**

Cook one heirloom dish with someone younger. Tell them the story behind it. You will pass down more than a meal.

☐ **Visit someone who is alone**

Many people grow quiet in their later years — not by choice. One visit can change their week, and reawaken yours.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 4

CONTRIBUTE

Offer Wisdom Without the Lecture

Wisdom kept private slowly fades. Wisdom shared multiplies.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

□ **Share one life lesson online**

Record a short video or write a short post about one thing life taught you. You are not bragging. You are leaving a light on for someone behind you.

□ **Offer a free, tiny workshop**

Teach one thing you know — gardening, budgeting, baking — at a library or community centre. Your everyday knowledge is someone else's breakthrough.

□ **Help one young person**

Review a CV. Listen to a business idea. Just listen. Your experience may be the mentorship they never knew to ask for.

□ **Start a family history recording**

Interview an older relative this week. Capture their voice. Stories disappear when no one presses record.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 5

EXPLORE

Use the Power of Novelty and Play

Curiosity is the antidote to drift.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

☐ **Be a tourist in your own town**

Visit a museum, market, or park you have walked past for years. Look at your everyday world with a traveller's eyes.

☐ **Fill a curiosity jar**

Write small adventures on slips of paper — salsa class, new café, paint something. Pull one out this week and simply go.

☐ **Try one new thing**

A new food. A new route. A new class. Novelty sharpens the brain and reminds you that the world is still wide open.

☐ **Take a “no-plan” day**

Once this week, wake with no to-do list. Follow your whims. Rediscover what spontaneity feels like.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 6

GROW

Grow Wisdom and Inner Alignment

Stillness is where insight settles.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

☐ **Open a curiosity window**

Choose one topic that genuinely interests you. Spend twenty quiet minutes with it, two or three times this week. No goal. Just attention.

☐ **Take a weekly reflection pause**

Set aside ten minutes. Ask: what did I learn this week — about life, or about myself? What felt right? What felt slightly off?

☐ **Run an alignment check-in**

Ask one honest question: where am I living by my values, and where am I just reacting? Then make one small adjustment.

☐ **Build a stillness ritual**

Pick one daily moment of quiet — morning breath, evening gratitude, a silent walk. Protect it. It is where clarity lives.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

PRACTICE 7

OPTIMIZE

Manage Your Resources by Your Design

Design your resources, or they will design you.

Pick one experiment to try this week:

□ **Do a ten-thing “stuff audit”**

Walk through one room with a box. Fill it with ten things you no longer need. Donate them. Lighten the space, lift the mind.

□ **Run a values spending audit**

Look at one month of expenses. Circle three that truly supported your health, relationships, or joy. Circle three that are just old habits. Shift gently.

□ **Start a small “Freedom Fund”**

Set aside a little each month for spontaneous adventures. Even a small amount can fund a big memory.

□ **Make a “gifting forward” plan**

Choose one way to invest in someone else’s growth — a grandchild’s learning, a young entrepreneur, a community project. Legacy can begin while you are here to watch it grow.

After your week, ask: *Did this give me energy, or drain it? What did it show me about the chapter I want to write next?*

The Best Is Still Ahead

Twenty-eight experiments. Half a year of small steps. You do not have to try them all, and you certainly do not have to try them in order.

Pick the one that makes you a little curious. Try it this week. Then come back and pick another.

You are not done. You are UnRetired. And this is exactly where the best chapters begin.

Keep this toolkit somewhere you will see it. A drawer you open often. A shelf by the kettle. Let it be the gentle nudge that turns one good week into a fuller life.

So — which one will you try first?

